

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Senior Manager, Model Risk Governance candidate with ~7 years across model risk management, model validation, and risk analytics at Moody's Analytics, EY, and Ortec Finance. Holds delegated sign-off authority on analytical outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios under a formal MRM framework with documentation standards and escalation protocols aligned with SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23 expectations. Practiced in policy and control documentation, exception identification and escalation, executive risk reporting, and model-output auditability. CFA charterholder, dual MSc; advanced Python and SQL; Excel/VBA and Power BI.

CORE SKILLS

Model Risk Management framework, policy & standards documentation • OSFI E-23 · SR 11-7 applied knowledge • Model validation, performance monitoring, exception tracking & issue escalation • Independent model review, challenge & delegated sign-off • Audit-ready documentation & internal control standards • Regulatory reporting & executive risk reporting • Python (advanced) · SQL (intermediate) · Excel/VBA (advanced) • Power BI (applied) · Git / version control • Stakeholder management across Risk, Finance & Audit functions

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services (Investment & ALM Risk Lead) | Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Model Governance, Sign-Off & Independent Review

- Holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs delivered to multi-asset institutional client portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement; ~\$50bn+ cumulative book).
- Operates within a formal model risk management framework – independently reviews curve construction, spread calibration, cross-asset assumptions, and economic defensibility prior to production release, consistent with SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23 documentation expectations.
- Escalates outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility; serves as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, interfacing directly with Heads of Risk and senior investment stakeholders.

Model Validation, Controls & Performance Monitoring

- Authors and maintains model documentation capturing behavioral assumptions, prepayment logic, and macro stress overlays – ensuring traceability and alignment with internal control and audit-readiness standards.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into auditable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging, validation checks, and version control – strengthening the governance audit trail for model outputs.
- Conducts model validation of derivatives pricing outputs (rates, FX, inflation) and cross-checks sensitivity consistency at portfolio-level aggregates; captures exceptions and tracks through to remediation, consistent with model performance monitoring and issue management processes.

Regulatory Reporting, Automation & Executive Communication

- Prepares analytical summaries and executive-level presentations for senior stakeholders covering interest-rate exposure, scenario impacts, and balance-sheet sensitivities – translating quantitative outputs into decision-ready narratives.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating code generation, validation scaffolding, and documentation – reducing development cycle time by an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.
- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios – covering model configuration, assumption embedding, and output validation across scope.

Client Service Specialist - PFaroe Platform | Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe analytics platform; validated model outputs post-deployment.

- Translated client investment-team requirements into structured Product Owner requests; supported model configuration scoping and post-deployment output attestation across all assigned accounts.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation | Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 technology-transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients – contributed to governance documentation, control design, and regulatory readiness processes.
- Coordinated across actuarial, IT, finance, and program-management functions on milestone delivery, ensuring cross-functional alignment on governance and reporting standards.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk | Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators and ALM models for Canadian and international pension-fund clients; supported model documentation that informed client-side governance and model validation processes.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization (VaR, CVaR) with risk decomposition and attribution using Ortec's GLASS platform; presented findings to investment committees.
- Led onboarding and ALM modelling for a three-plan university pension merger – co-developed and validated the model capturing all Funding Policy dynamics, evaluating duration, currency, inflation, and leverage overlay strategies.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016